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**THE SECRETARY OF VETERANS AFFAIRS
WASHINGTON**

January 29, 2026

Maggie Wiśniewska, Ph.D.
Science Policy Advisor - International Laboratory Methods
Laboratory Investigations Department
People for the Ethical Treatment of Animals
1536 16th Street, NW
Washington, DC 20036

Dear Dr. Wiśniewska:

Thank you for your December 9, 2025, letter regarding animal research being conducted at the Department of Veterans Affairs (VA). VA's first priority is to provide the best care and services to our Nation's Veterans.

It is VA policy to conduct research with animals that is needed to fulfill VA's mission of serving Veterans in ways that meet or exceed established legal, ethical, and veterinary standards for the appropriate care of the animals involved in research. VA supports research with animals only when it is the best method available to obtain information needed to effectively address the health care needs of Veterans and when there are not validated new approach methodologies available that would meet the study's objectives. Scientists and the local Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee review each project by to ensure that the project is relevant to Veterans' health, scientifically sound, and designed to maximize translatability of the data before a project is approved.

Thank you for your continued support of our mission.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Douglas A. Collins", with a large, stylized loop at the end.

Douglas A. Collins